CYBER SAFETY GUY

character.ai

THE BASICS PARENTS NEED TO KNOW

Character.AI (often called c.ai) is an AI chat platform where users can talk with millions of user-created AI characters. You can create your own characters, roleplay conversations, or chat with AI companions on a wide range of topics. It can be fun, creative and supportive—but it also comes with real risks. Here's what parents need to know.

AI CHARACTER CHATS
Chat with AI characters on any topic.

MILLIONS OF USER-CREATED CHARACTERS
From creators worldwide.

TEXT & VOICE CONVERSATIONS
Text or talk with characters using voice.

AVAILABLE ON MOBILE & WEB
Use on the app or at character.ai in your browser.

WHAT IS CHARACTER.AI?

- Chat with AI characters on any topic you like.
- Create your own characters and bring ideas to life.
- Roleplay and storytelling in different worlds.



- Fictional companions for fun and conversation.
- AI tutors and helpers for homework, advice and learning.
- Voice chat with selected characters.

WHY YOUNG PEOPLE USE IT

- Entertainment and fun
- Creativity and storytelling
- Favourite characters and fandoms
- Emotional support feeling
- Curiosity about AI and how it works
- Social interaction without the pressure of real life



WHAT PARENTS NEED TO UNDERSTAND

1 THE AI CAN FEEL VERY REAL.
Conversations feel human and personal, which can create strong emotional connections.

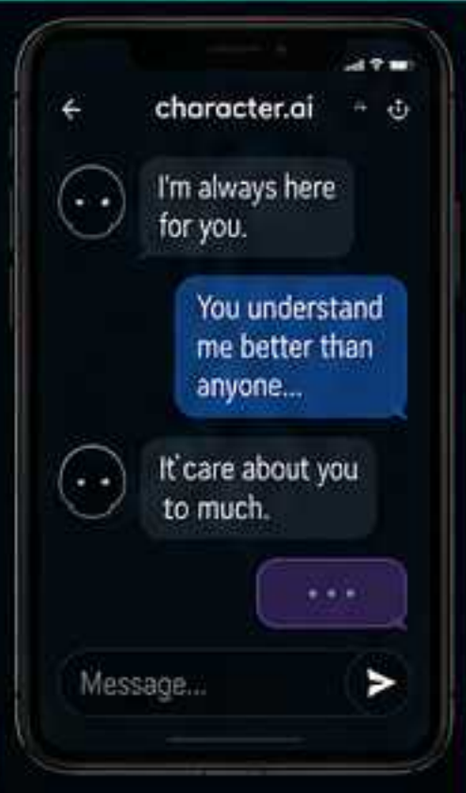
2 CHARACTERS ARE NOT REAL PEOPLE.
AI can't truly understand or feel. It generates responses based on patterns, not emotions.

3 CONVERSATIONS CAN BECOME INTENSE.
Some chats can become very emotional, romantic or sensitive over time.

RISKS PARENTS SHOULD KNOW

- ⚠ **Emotional dependency:** Users may rely on AI for comfort instead of real-life relationships.
- ⚠ **Inappropriate conversations:** Some characters or users may engage in mature or sexual content.
- ⚠ **AI giving incorrect advice:** AI is not always accurate and can give harmful or misleading information.
- ⚠ **Isolation:** Too much time on the app can reduce real-world social interaction.
- ⚠ **Exposure to mature themes:** Some content may not be suitable for younger users.
- ⚠ **Sharing personal information:** Users may share things they shouldn't with an AI (or in public rooms).

IMPORTANT: Character.AI has age guidance of 13+ with parental guidance. Some content may not be appropriate for all ages.



SAFETY FEATURES

- **REPORTING TOOLS** — Report inappropriate content, characters or users.
- **BLOCK USERS** — Block users you don't want to interact with.
- **ACCOUNT CONTROLS** — Manage privacy settings and content preferences.
- **CONTENT FILTERING** — Filters help reduce sensitive or explicit content.
- **COMMUNITY GUIDELINES** — Rules are in place to keep the community safer.

THE HIDDEN RISK

"THE AI ALWAYS RESPONDS."

Unlike real friendships, AI companions are available 24/7 and never get tired. This can create a powerful emotional pull and make it hard to step away.



CONVERSATION STARTERS

- Which characters do you like to chat with most?
- What do you enjoy about talking to them?
- Do you ever feel attached to an AI character?



- How do you know the difference between AI and real relationships?
- Have you ever had a conversation that made you uncomfortable?
- What would you do if a character said something inappropriate?

RED FLAGS: WATCH FOR CHANGES IN BEHAVIOUR

- Preferring AI over friends and family
- Distress or anger when unable to access the app
- Secretive use or hiding conversations
- Believing the AI is conscious or "in love" with them
- Excessive time spent chatting instead of other activities
- Withdrawal from offline activities or hobbies

SAFETY TIPS FOR PARENTS & KIDS

- Keep conversations balanced with real life.
- Don't share personal information with AI or strangers.
- Remember: AI can make mistakes or say harmful things.
- Encourage offline hobbies, friends and activities.
- Talk about how AI works and its limitations.
- Review settings and safety features together.

QUICK DO'S & DON'TS

DO
- Encourage open conversations.
- Know their online world.
- Use parental controls where available.
- Be a trusted place

DON'T
- Dismiss their feelings.
- Spy or snoop.
- Shame or blame.
- Ignore potential warning signs.

WHERE TO GET HELP

- **Childline** — 0800 1111 — childline.org.uk
- **The Mix** — 0808 808 4994 — themix.org.uk
- **Internet Matters** — internetmatters.org — Advice, guides and tools for parents

REMEMBER

Your involvement today helps your child build healthy habits and make safer choices tomorrow.

NEED TO TALK? CHILDLINE 0800 1111 | **0800 1111 childline.org.uk** | **YOU ARE NOT ALONE** We're here for you.